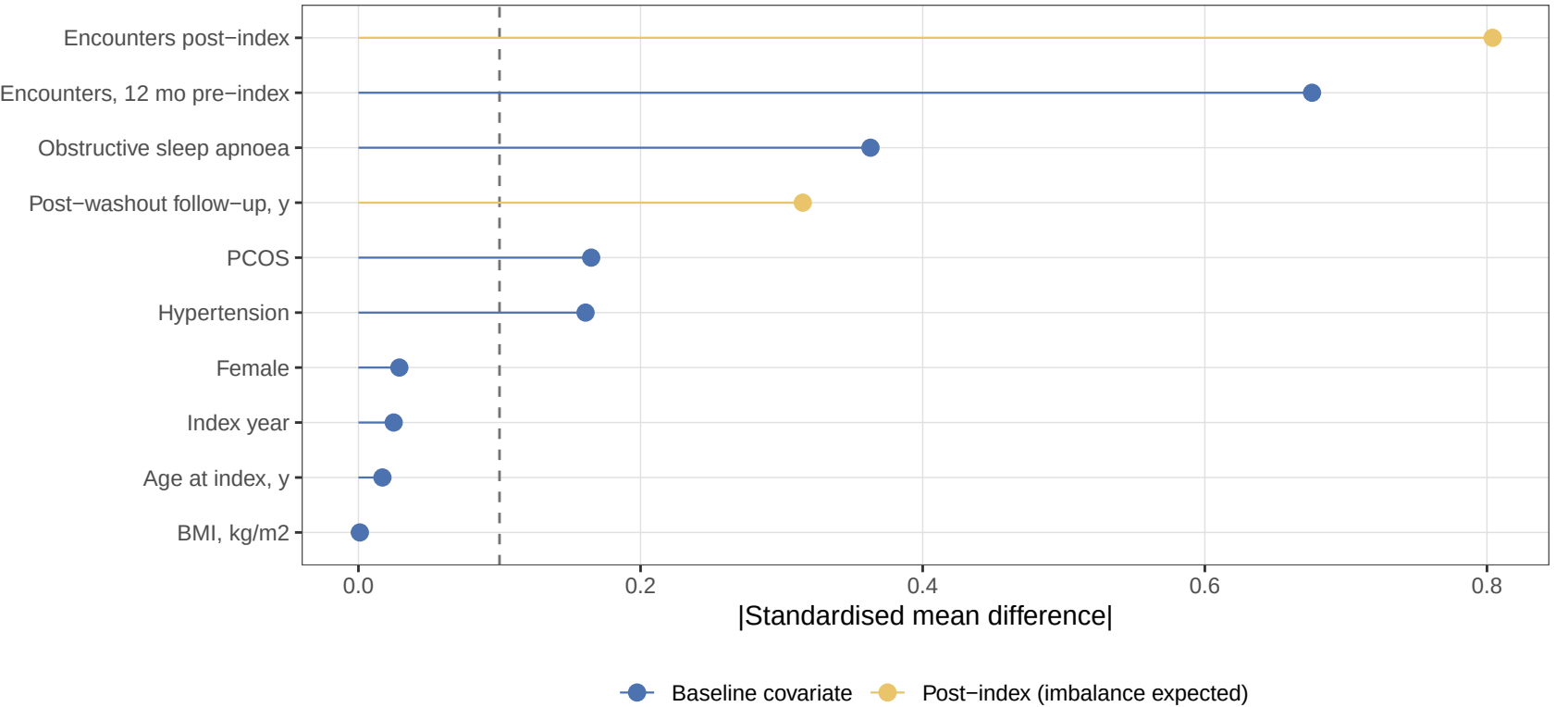


Covariate balance after matching

Dashed line = 0.1. Propensity c-statistic 0.513.



Matched targets (age, BMI, sex, index year) are balanced. Comorbidity and healthcare contact were NOT matched on and remain imbalanced; they are confounders the design does not close.